User Story Map

Map the user's journey, then slice it into releases that each deliver a complete, usable path.

Break Down Work · Inspired by Jeff Patton's Story Mapping · Walking Skeleton · Release Slices

LEGEND

- Blue Sticky = Activity (backbone)
- Yellow Sticky = User Task
- Green Sticky = Story / Detail

Persona / user: _____ Their goal: _____ Product / epic: _____

1 Activities

The backbone: the big things users do, in order

USER JOURNEY → LEFT TO RIGHT, IN THE ORDER USERS DO THINGS

...one sticky per step, left to right

2 User Tasks

The walking skeleton: steps within each activity

UNDER EACH ACTIVITY

...one sticky per step, left to right

RELEASE SLICES: STORIES GO BELOW EACH TASK, MOST IMPORTANT AT THE TOP. EACH SLICE IS A COMPLETE PATH

Release 1 · MVP

The thinnest slice that lets a user reach their goal end-to-end

Outcome: _____

Target: _____

Stories for this slice, under the task they belong to

Release 2

Makes the journey better: more options, fewer errors

Outcome: _____

Target: _____

Stories for this slice, under the task they belong to

Later

Nice to have. Revisit after learning from earlier releases

Outcome: _____

Target: _____

Stories for this slice, under the task they belong to

"What's the smallest slice that lets a user reach their goal end-to-end?"

"What will we learn from releasing this slice?"

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